

The Boston Globe

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SATURDAY, OCTOBER 18, 2025

AHEAD ON THE CHARLES



BEN PENNINGTON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Rowers took to the Charles Friday morning near the Boston University DeWolfe Boathouse during the Head of the Charles Regatta. Several veteran and grand master sculling events were held on Friday morning. Head of the Charles cofounder D'Arcy MacMahon, 86, marked the 60th anniversary of the inaugural regatta by racing in Friday's grand veteran singles, using his original Sims wooden shell. The regatta continues on Saturday and Sunday. **C1.**

N.E. scientists face 'chaos and confusion'

Shutdown, layoffs, uncertainty prevent planning on public, private fronts

By Sabrina Shankman and Kate Selig
GLOBE STAFF

Scientists and researchers across New England are bracing for a second round of cuts from the Trump administration that could hit soon, after dozens of energy and environmental programs lost funding in early October.

Massachusetts has already lost about \$466 million in grants clawed

►Woods Hole Oceanographic Institution has a fund-raising goal of \$500 million. **D1.**

back by the Department of Energy as part of a sweeping round of reductions that seemed aimed at causing pain for blue states. The department said the cuts were part of an effort to curb wasteful spending approved by the Biden administration.

Since the government shutdown

began on Oct. 1, many private sector scientists and researchers say they have been stuck in a state of quasi-paralysis — not able to communicate with counterparts in federal agencies, unsure whether they may lose additional funding, and unclear whether they will ever be able to count on federal grants again.

Within the federal agencies, it's even worse, with the specter of further firings and program cuts looming. "We are closing up Democrat programs that we disagree with, and they're never going to open again," President Trump said at a

press conference on Tuesday.

There's expected to be another round of firings for federal employees, too. Since the shutdown began, some 4,000 federal employees nationwide have lost their jobs. In an appearance on "The Charlie Kirk Show" on Wednesday, White House budget director Russ Vought said, "We'll probably end up being north of 10,000."

Across the country, the Department of Energy has already pulled awards worth \$7.6 billion from 223 projects, many of them supporting

ENERGY, Page A6

President Trump said he had commuted the sentence of former US representative George Santos, who is serving more than seven years in prison for fraud and identity theft. **A9.**

Prince Andrew said he is giving up his royal title of the Duke of York after his friendship with sex offender Jeffrey Epstein returned to the headlines. **A6.**

A Vermont state senator who took part in a controversial group chat among young Republicans said he would resign his legislative seat early next week. **B2.**

Artificial intelligence start-up Lila Sciences is leasing 244,000 square feet at IQHQ's Alewife Park laboratory campus. **D1.**

Gravel plant questions housing plan



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

The giant Boston Sand & Gravel complex has operated on the edge of Charlestown for decades, amid highways full of commuters.

Charlestown mainstay, developer at odds over safety of neighbors

By Catherine Carlock
GLOBE STAFF

In its six decades operating off the industrial edge of Charlestown's New Rutherford Avenue, the giant Boston Sand & Gravel complex has never had a neighbor.

Now, 705 apartments might go in on some empty parking lots next door. The industrial stalwart is pushing back, worried that its massive trucks and all those people could make for a bad mix.

It's an uncomfortable ten-

sion between one of the last remaining vestiges of heavy industry that has made much of Boston what it is — both above ground and in the tunnels below — and the sort of large-scale housing the city needs if it's to keep growing. The conflict is playing out along much of this corridor between Sullivan Square and Bunker Hill Community College, where a number of new development proposals promise to transform an area that

GRAVEL, Page A12

Mass. high schoolers may face end-of-course tests

But critics cite vote to end MCAS graduation rule

By Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

WORCESTER — Just a year after Massachusetts voters resoundingly overturned using the 10th grade MCAS exam as a graduation requirement, state leaders are sparking debate by recommending end-of-course state-administered tests for high schoolers.

Some members of an advisory council on graduation requirements say they fear such exams would just create another high-stakes test and overturn the will of the voters. Other members of the council worry

the proposed recommendation would not go far enough toward establishing a baseline high school diploma.

The Massachusetts Teachers Association was the primary backer of the 2024 ballot measure that overturned the MCAS graduation requirement, ending the state's two-decade use of its annual state accountability tests as a high school exit exam. The MTA had long argued the requirement forced schools to narrowly teach to the test, caused too much anxiety among students, unfairly punished poor test takers, and was potentially discriminatory.

With the requirement now gone, the question is, how does Massachusetts still ensure that students finish high school

TESTS, Page A12

Voters divided on use of Guard

Some see retribution, others say they're needed

By Brian MacQuarrie, Omar Mohammed, Steven Porter, Sabrina Shankman, Edward Fitzpatrick, and Diti Kohli of the Globe staff

When Sidney Trantham, a 56-year-old clinical psychologist from Boston, sees National Guard troops moving into big American cities, he sees a partisan strategy to score political points more than keeping the peace.

"I think that there's a lot of distortion about violent crime happening in this country," said Trantham, an unenrolled voter who backed Kamala Harris for president in 2024. "It is very clear that what the president is doing is about politics. And it's about ginning up the base."

Trantham's concerns about President Trump's use of the National Guard were shared by most voters in the latest Globe survey of a set group of New Englanders. In the survey, 11 voters ranging across the political spectrum — eight voted for Harris, three for Trump — were asked about crime rates, immigration enforcement, Trump's deployment of the National Guard to US cities, and whether they feel safer as a result.

Nearly all voters were sharply critical of the president, although two strongly endorsed Trump's deployment of the Guard, reflecting rising tensions about the president's decision. Mass pro-democracy protests against the Trump administra-

VOTERS, Page A9

Military families on edge as they wait for pay

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

Heather H. has been a military spouse for more than a decade. She and her four young children rely on her husband's paychecks to stay afloat, she said.

As the federal shutdown stretches into its third week, she is worried about their immediate future.

"It's frustrating for us to see the families bearing that cost. This financial stress is distracting to members who are already providing vital defense services for the nation," said the 39-year-old from southern New Hampshire, who declined to provide her last name to protect her husband's identity. "This should not be what the military has to worry about."

As Democrats and Republicans remain locked in a bitter standoff over spending, active-duty troop pay has become collateral damage. During previous closures, Congress has passed bipartisan provisions to ensure military personnel, whose work is deemed essential for national security, continued earning their salaries.

MILITARY, Page A8

ZELENSKY IN WASHINGTON



ANDREW HARNIK/GETTY IMAGES

President Trump and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy met Friday at the White House, where Trump signaled he's leaning against selling Ukraine long-range Tomahawk missiles. **A4.**

Rake in the action

Saturday: Mostly sunny. High: 59-64. Low: 48-53.
Sunday: Sunny, warmer. High: 64-69. Low: 54-59.
Sunrise: 7:01 Sunset: 5:57
Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **C11.**

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